

# WTF is

## Paperclip?

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If OpenClaw is a single AI employee and Polsia is a managed company service, Paperclip is the org chart. The open-source framework for running entire companies with teams of AI agents — each with a role, a set of tools, and a goal.

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# The one-liner

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**Paperclip is an open-source orchestration framework that lets you build a multi-agent "company org chart" — assigning roles, workflows, and goals across multiple AI agents that coordinate together to run a business.**

Tagline: "Any agent, any runtime, one org chart."

It is not a managed service like Polsia. It is not a single personal agent like OpenClaw. It is infrastructure — the coordination layer that sits above individual agents and makes them work as a team.

## The key insight — agents need coordination

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Running a company — even a small one — requires multiple types of work happening simultaneously. A developer building the product. A marketer generating leads. A support agent handling customers. A finance agent tracking revenue.

A single AI agent can do any one of these things. But coordinating all of them — making sure the developer knows what the marketer is promising, that the support agent knows what the product can do, that the finance agent tracks what the sales agent closes — requires something more than a single agent.

**That is what Paperclip does. It gives each agent a role, connects them, and coordinates their work toward a shared goal.**

## How it works

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Paperclip is built on Node.js with a React UI. You self-host it — it runs on your own machine or server.

### The org chart model

You define your company as an org chart. Each node in the chart is an agent with:

- A role (CEO, Marketing Lead, Developer, Support Agent)
- A set of tools (web browser, code editor, email, database access)
- A goal (grow revenue, ship features, resolve tickets)
- Reporting lines (which agents it coordinates with)

### The runtime

Paperclip is "runtime agnostic" — it does not care which AI agents or tools you use. You can plug in Claude Code for development, OpenClaw for communications, Cursor for code editing, and any other MCP-compatible tool. The framework coordinates them regardless of origin.

## Supported agents and tools

From the Paperclip GitHub release notes:

- Claude Code (Anthropic)
- OpenClaw
- Cursor (AI code editor)
- OpenCode
- Codex (OpenAI)
- Pi (Inflection AI)

## ClipMart — the killer feature coming soon

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**The most anticipated feature in Paperclip is ClipMart — a marketplace listed as "COMING SOON" on the GitHub repository as of March 2026.**

The description from the GitHub README:

*"Download and run entire companies with one click. Browse pre-built company templates — full org structures, agent configs, and skills — and import them into your Paperclip instance in seconds."*

If ClipMart delivers on this promise, it means you will be able to download a pre-built "roofing company" or "content agency" or "SaaS analytics tool" — complete with the full agent org chart, configured tools, and pre-written workflows — and be running it within minutes.

This would make Paperclip the most powerful self-hosted alternative to Polsia — with the added advantage of owning everything yourself and paying no revenue share.

## The GitHub story

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**Paperclip accumulated 13,500 GitHub stars within days of its open-source launch — a remarkable velocity that signals significant developer interest.**

The founder of Paperclip has not been publicly identified in available press as of March 2026. The project is listed under the "paperclipai" GitHub organisation. This anonymity is unusual for a project of this scale — but not unprecedented in the open-source world.

Active releases are available on GitHub at [github.com/paperclipai/paperclip](https://github.com/paperclipai/paperclip). The community is growing. The codebase is being actively maintained.

## Paperclip vs OpenClaw vs Polsia

|                  | Paperclip                           | OpenClaw            | Polsia                   |
|------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|
| What it is       | Multi-agent orchestration framework | Personal AI agent   | Managed company platform |
| Runs where       | Your servers (self-hosted)          | Your machine        | Polsia's servers         |
| Cost             | Free (open source)                  | Free (+ LLM costs)  | \$50/mo + 20% revenue    |
| Number of agents | Many (org chart)                    | One                 | Many (managed)           |
| Technical level  | High (developer)                    | Medium (CLI)        | Low (no-code)            |
| Best for         | Building multi-agent companies      | Personal automation | Quick company launch     |
| Open source      | Yes                                 | Yes (MIT)           | No                       |

## Who is Paperclip for?

### Developers building AI-native companies

If you are technical and want to build something real — not a demo, not a prototype — Paperclip gives you the infrastructure to coordinate multiple agents at production scale. You own everything. You pay no revenue share. You have full control.

### Founders who want to move fast

Once ClipMart launches, Paperclip becomes accessible to non-developers — download a company template, configure it, run it. The technical barrier drops significantly.

### Enterprises building custom agent workflows

Paperclip's "any agent, any runtime" philosophy makes it attractive for enterprises that want to build on their existing tools — connecting existing Claude Code deployments, OpenClaw agents, and custom tools into a coordinated system.

### Not for:

Complete beginners who want a no-code solution right now. For that, Polsia is the better starting point.

# The bigger picture — orchestration is the next battleground

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**As AI agents become more capable, the question shifts from "can an agent do this task?" to "how do you coordinate many agents doing many tasks?"**

Paperclip is not alone in this space. CrewAI and LangGraph are the dominant open-source orchestration frameworks in the broader developer community. Google's Agent Development Kit (ADK) is the enterprise entry. Salesforce Agentforce is the CRM-native approach.

What makes Paperclip interesting is its focus on the specific use case of running companies — not just workflows. The org chart metaphor is intuitive, ClipMart has genuine viral potential, and the open-source community is active.

Watch this space. Paperclip launched in March 2026 with 13,500 GitHub stars in days. By the time you read this, the numbers will be higher.

## Glossary

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**Paperclip** — Open-source multi-agent orchestration framework. Build and run companies with teams of AI agents. Self-hosted.

**Orchestration** — The coordination of multiple AI agents working together — assigning roles, managing communication, directing toward shared goals.

**ClipMart** — Paperclip's upcoming marketplace for pre-built company templates. Download and run an entire AI company with one click.

**Org chart model** — Paperclip's approach: each agent is a node in a company org chart with a defined role, tools, and reporting lines.

**Runtime agnostic** — Paperclip works with any AI agent or tool — it does not require a specific LLM or agent platform.

**Self-hosted** — Software you run on your own servers, as opposed to a managed service run by the provider.

**CrewAI** — A competing open-source multi-agent orchestration framework, widely used in the developer community.

**LangGraph** — The advanced version of LangChain for building stateful, multi-agent workflows. A major competitor to Paperclip.

**Node.js** — The JavaScript runtime that Paperclip's server is built on.

**MCP-compatible** — Supports the Model Context Protocol — Anthropic's open standard for connecting agents to tools and data.

## Liked this? Go deeper.

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Paperclip is one piece. Here is the full picture.

### WTF is OpenClaw

The open source alternative taking on Palsia. Self-hosted, community-driven, and growing fast.

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### WTF is Claude

Anthropic's AI model. The family, the new Fable and Mythos tier, what it can do, and why it powers so many agents — including rivals' products.

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### WTF is Palsia

The one-person startup that raised \$30M to let AI run your company. What is real, what it costs, and who it is actually for.

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### WTF is the Agentic Economy

The big picture. What actually happened in 2026, who the players are, what is real and what is hype. Start here.

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### How to Hire an AI Agent for Your Business

A practical, jargon-free guide for business owners who want to start using AI agents right now.

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